

WATCHNOW

Visual Design Specification

A page-by-page visual and implementation guide for the personalized movie discovery experience.



DESIGN HANDOFF • VERSION 1.1

Design direction

Cinematic, intelligent, and personal - never a generic dashboard.

Cinematic first

Darkness and selective glow create atmosphere without hurting clarity.

Personal by default

Ratings, watchlist state, and taste signals recur throughout.

Fast decisions

The path from landing to five strong choices is always obvious.

Dense, not cluttered

Compact cards use consistent spacing and strong hierarchy.

Visual system

Use these values consistently. Representative movie posters belong in the design prototype before live data is connected.



Midnight
#040D16



Navigation
#061321



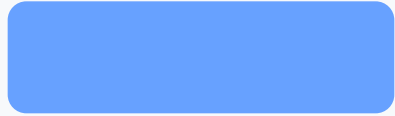
Panel
#0A1A29



Raised
#0D2235



Electric blue
#2F7BFF



Soft blue
#67A1FF



Text
#F6F8FC



Muted
#91A1B2



Rating
#FFC642

TYPE

Inter or Geist

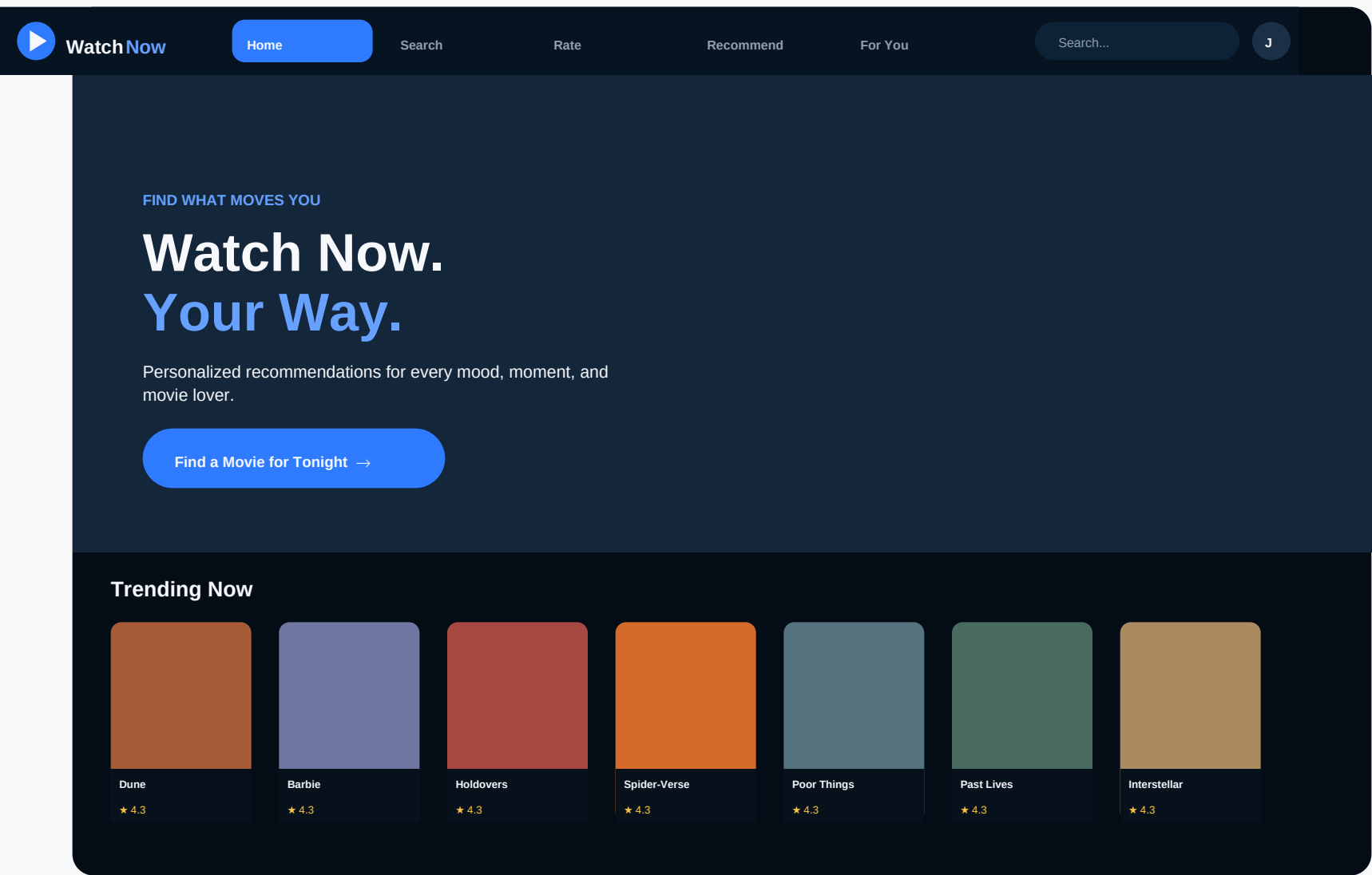
One sans-serif family. Headlines 700, interface 500-600, body 400.

LAYOUT AND IMAGERY

- 8 px spacing grid
- 64-72 px desktop gutters
- 12-16 px panel radius
- 1 px #18334A borders
- Use fixed sample posters now; replace image URLs when the movie API is integrated

Home

Discovery-first landing page



IMPLEMENTATION NOTES

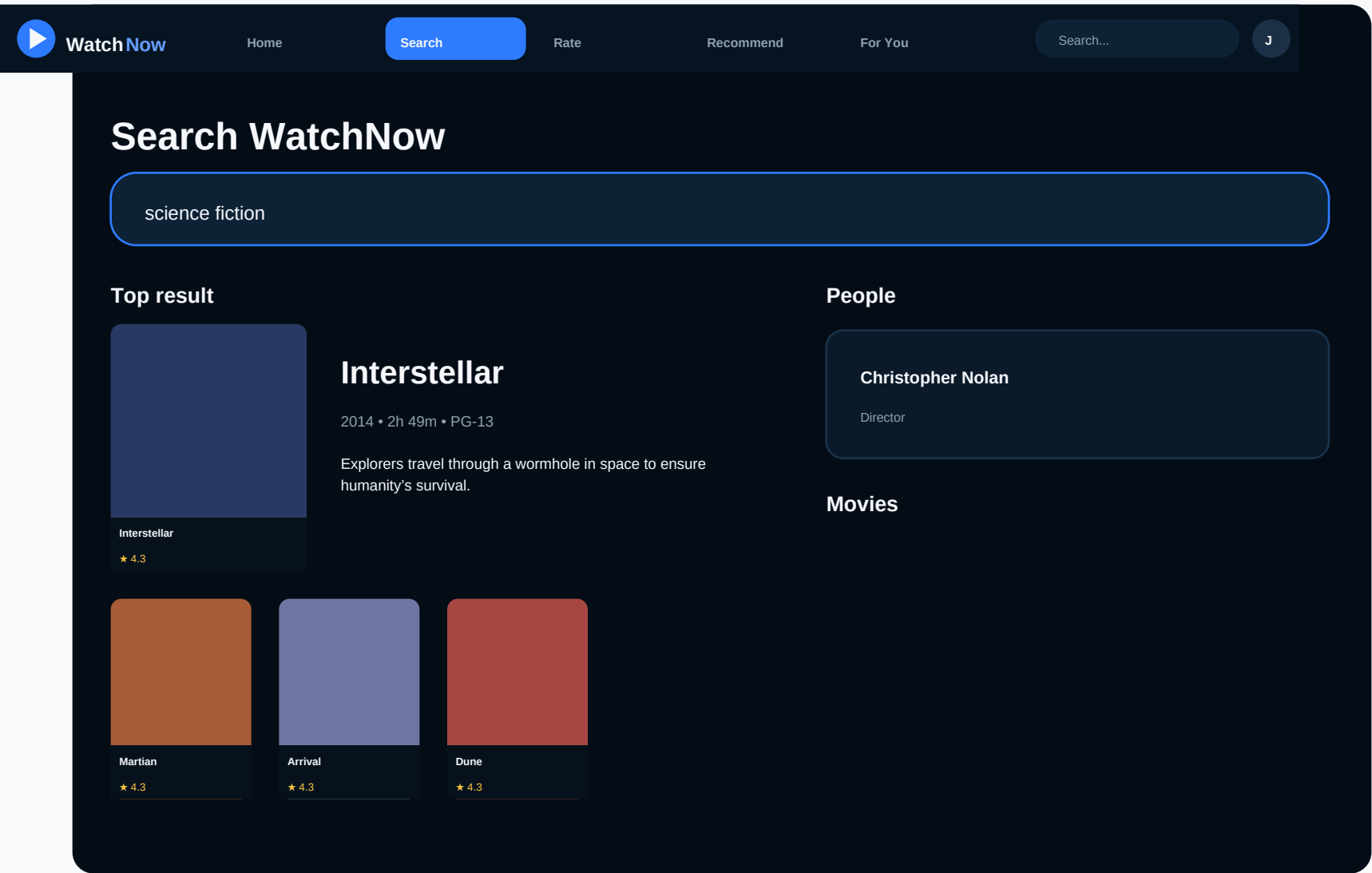
- Hero occupies roughly 45% of the first viewport.
- Headline is exactly “Watch Now. Your Way.”
- Primary CTA opens Recommend; featured title opens details.
- Rows scroll horizontally and keep card metadata concise.

KEY STATES

loading • first visit • personalized

Search

One search box, multiple result types



IMPLEMENTATION NOTES

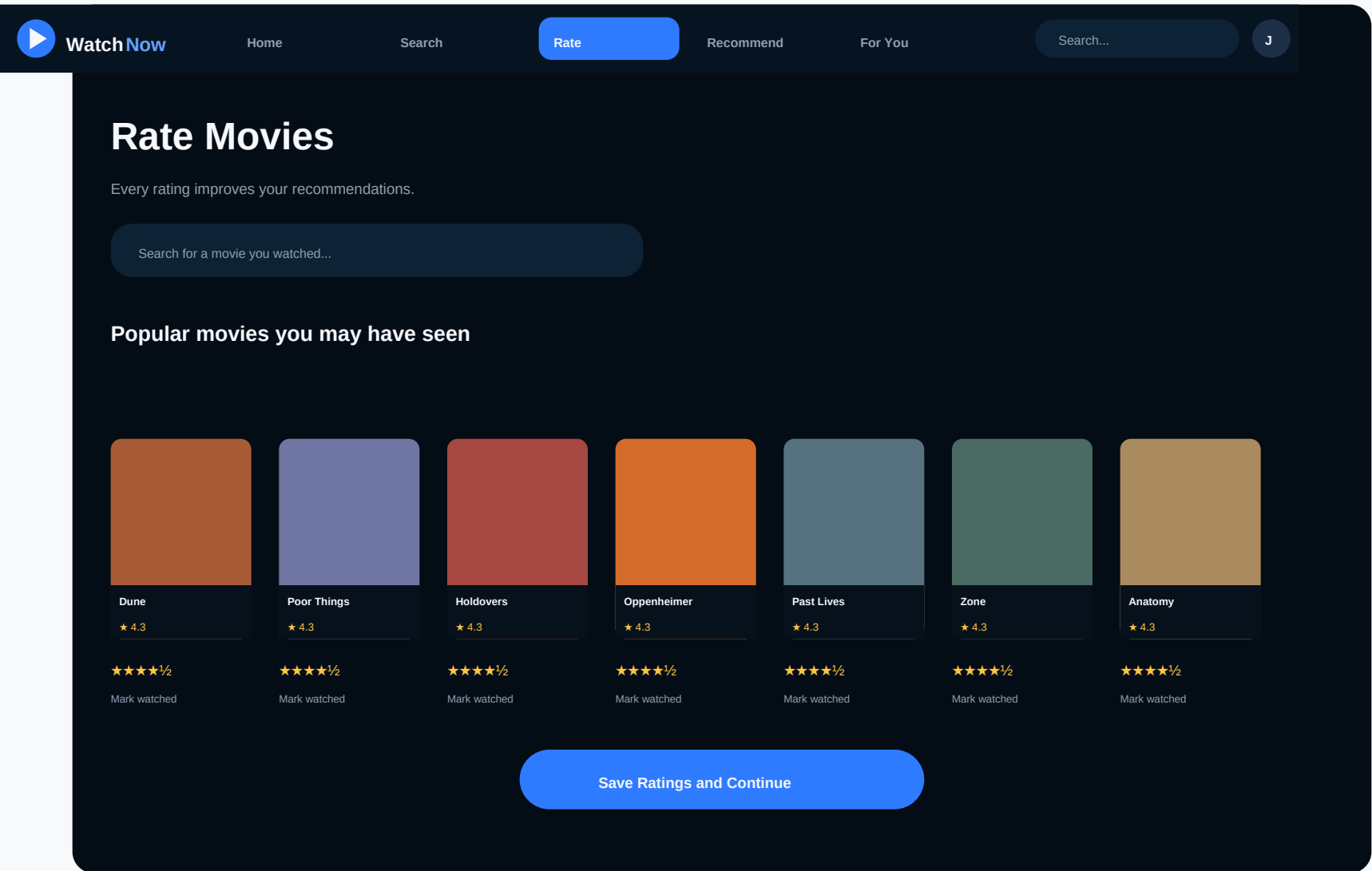
- Group results into top match, people, movies, and genres.
- Do not require a search type before typing.
- Use a 300 ms debounce and keyboard-accessible suggestions.
- No-results state offers spelling and genre alternatives.

KEY STATES

idle • typing • results • no results • error

Rate

Fast preference training



IMPLEMENTATION NOTES

- Watched and Rated remain separate states.
- Stars support 0.5 to 5.0 in half-star steps.
- Rating automatically marks a movie watched.
- Show a session counter and save confirmation.

KEY STATES

unrated • watched • rated • saved

Recommend

The signature movie-night flow

Watch Now Home Search Rate **Recommend** For You Search... J

Find a Movie for Tonight

Choose the mood and context for right now.

Mood

Funny Exciting Relaxing

Watching with

Solo Partner Friends

Time

<90 90-120 2+ hours

Experience

Easy Engaging Intense

Discovery

Get My Recommendations →

Your Recommendations

Grand Hotel	Knives Out	La La Land	Dune	Martian
★ 4.3	★ 4.3	★ 4.3	★ 4.3	★ 4.3

IMPLEMENTATION NOTES

- All filters fit above the fold on desktop.
- Selected chips are electric blue.
- Discovery runs from Safe Pick to Surprise Me.
- Return five results with longer synopses and no Why this block.

KEY STATES

incomplete • loading • results • no match

Movie Details

A decision page, not a streaming page

Watch Now

Home

Search

Rate

Recommend

For You

Search...

J

Dune: Part Two

2024 • 2h 46m • PG-13

Paul Atreides unites with Chani and the Fremen while seeking revenge against those who destroyed his family.

+ Add to Watchlist

Dune: Part Two

★ 4.3

Your rating ★★★★★

Where to watch

Max

Prime Video

Apple TV

Hulu

Cast and crew

Timothée • Zendaya • Villeneuve

IMPLEMENTATION NOTES

- Primary actions are Watchlist, Watched, Rating, and Not Interested.
- Show runtime, year, certification, genres, synopsis, cast, and director.
- Provider buttons are outbound links, never play controls.
- Persist state immediately with brief confirmation feedback.

KEY STATES

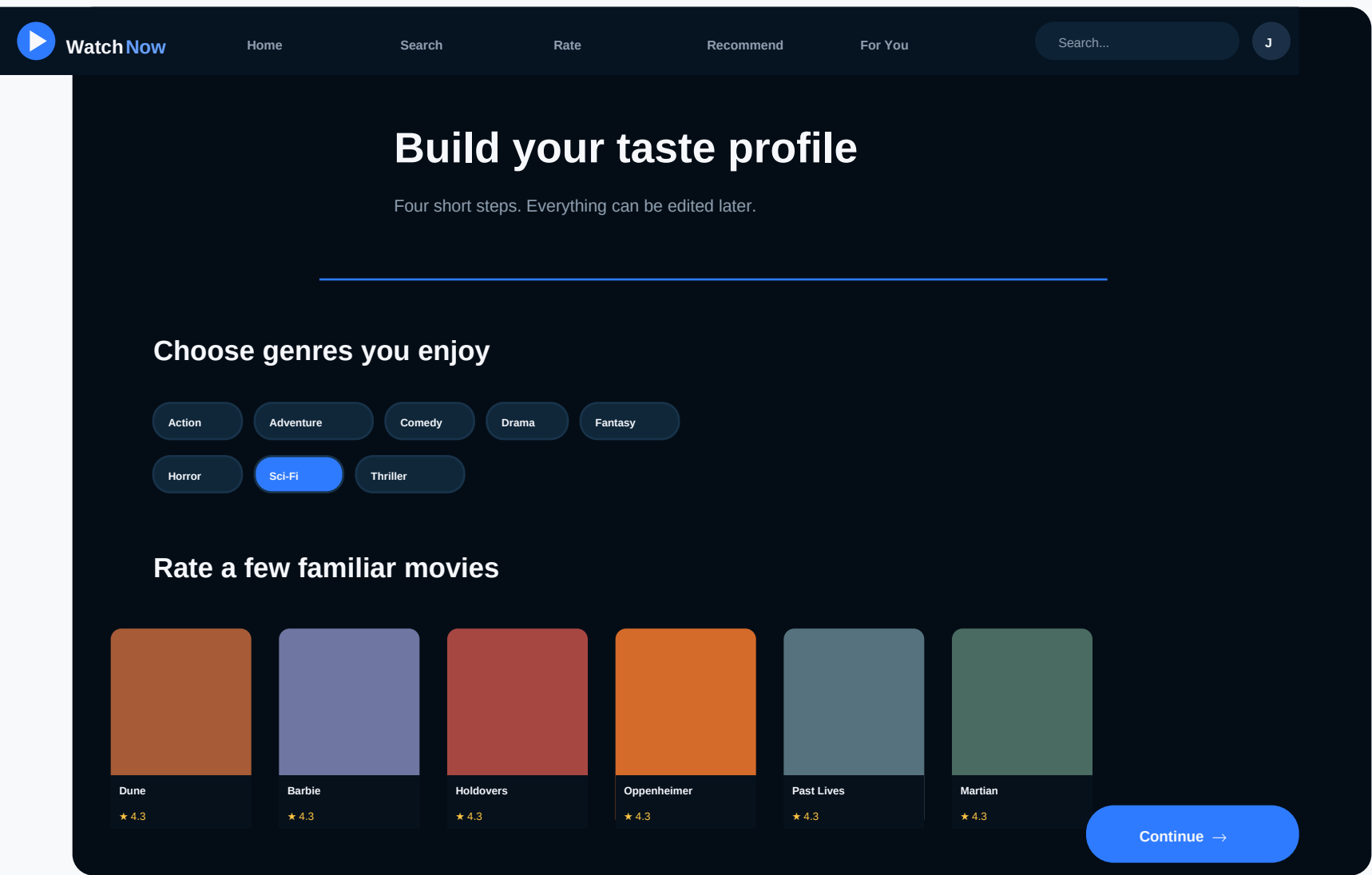
unseen • watched • rated • unavailable

WATCHNOW • VISUAL DESIGN SPECIFICATION

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Onboarding

Solve cold start without a survey



IMPLEMENTATION NOTES

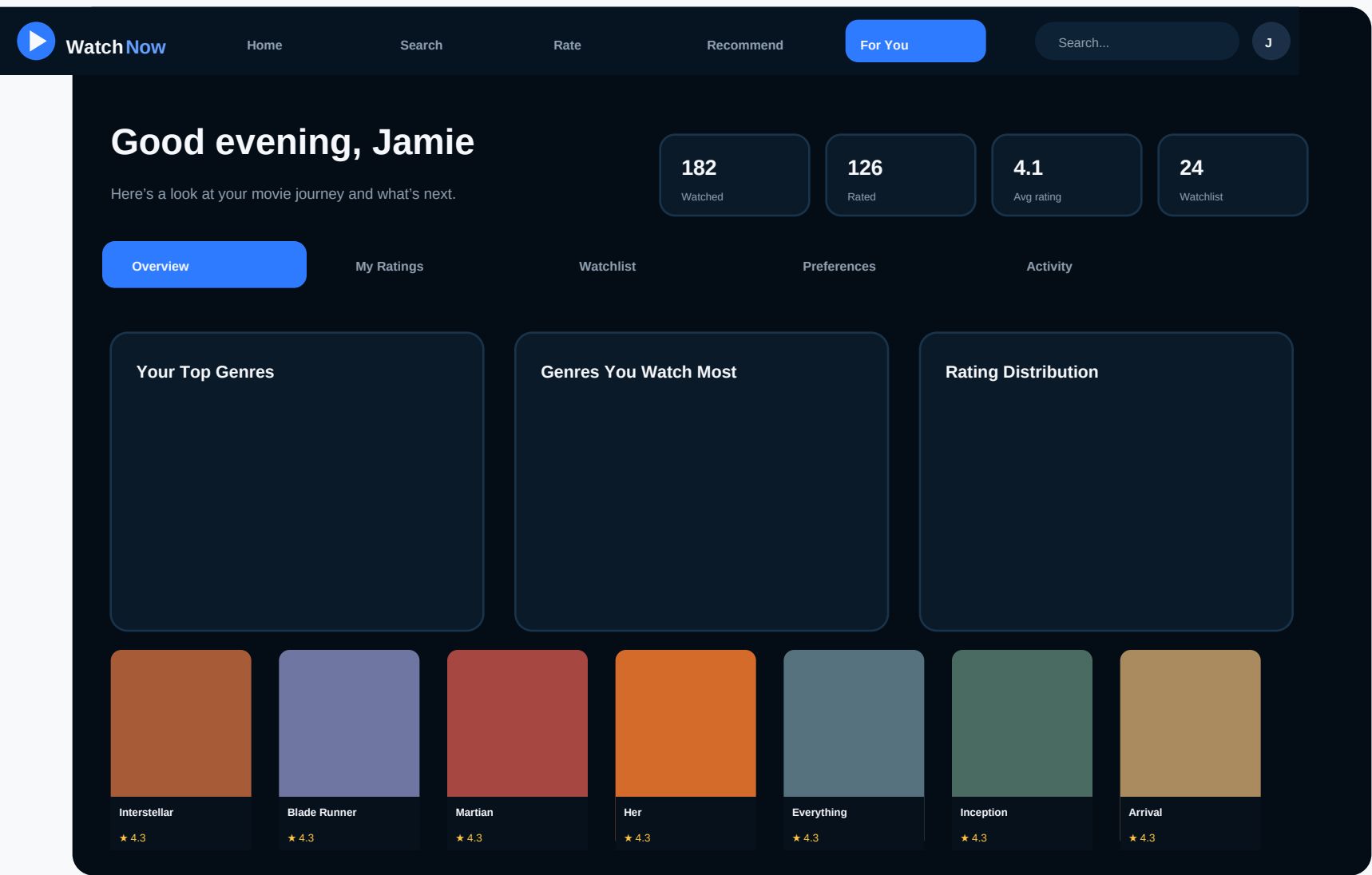
- Four steps: genres, familiar movies, runtime and era, discovery.
- Every step can be skipped and progress stays visible.
- Ask for about five ratings, not twenty required ratings.
- Finish on Home with a personalized first row.

KEY STATES

steps 1-4 • skipped • complete

For You Overview

Taste dashboard and next actions



IMPLEMENTATION NOTES

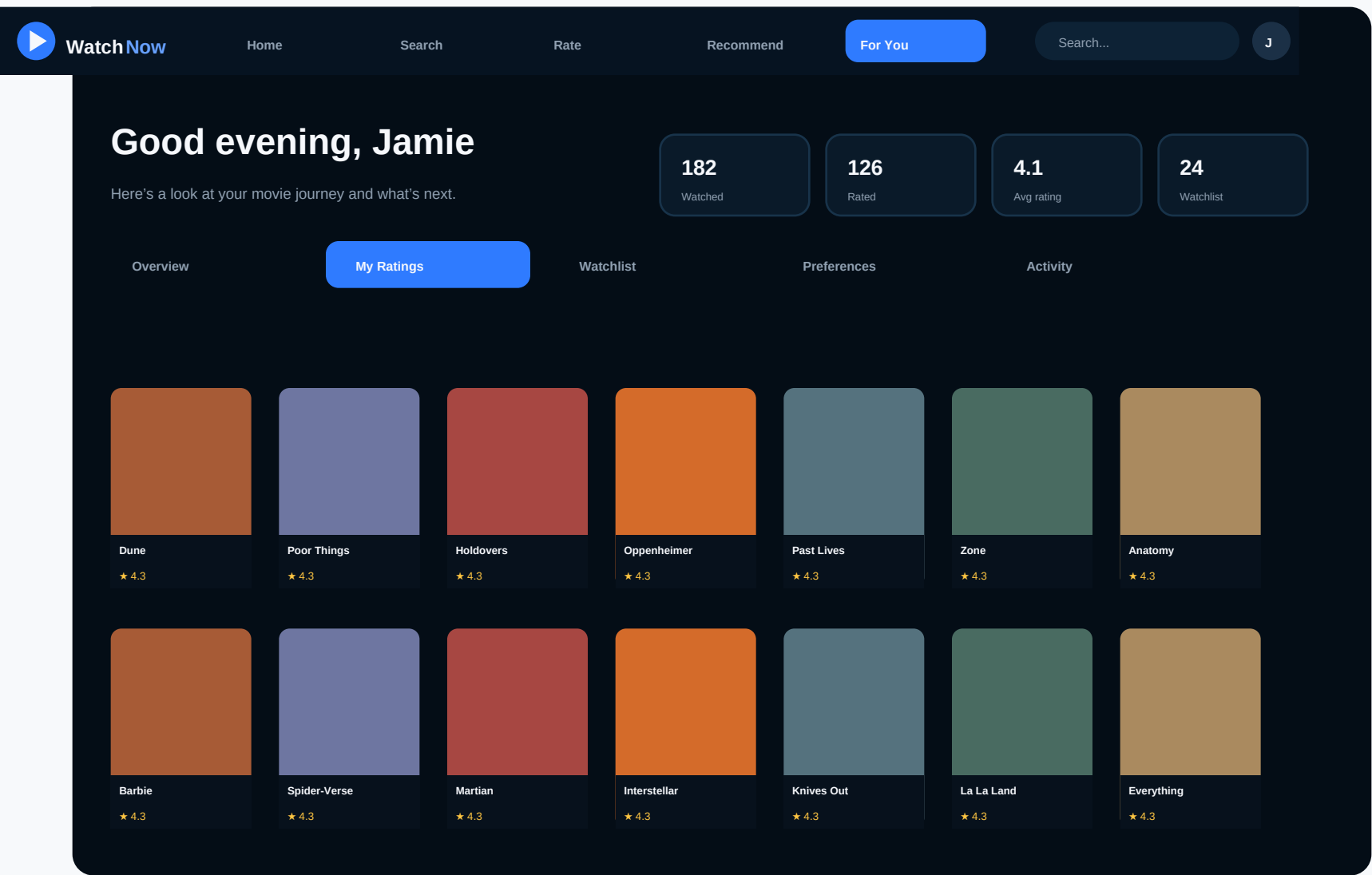
- Top Genres means highest average rating; Watch Most means volume.
- Use four summary metrics and directly labeled charts.
- Lower sections show activity, watchlist, and recommendations.
- All cards align to a 12-column grid.

KEY STATES

new user • established • sparse data

For You My Ratings

Sortable rating history



IMPLEMENTATION NOTES

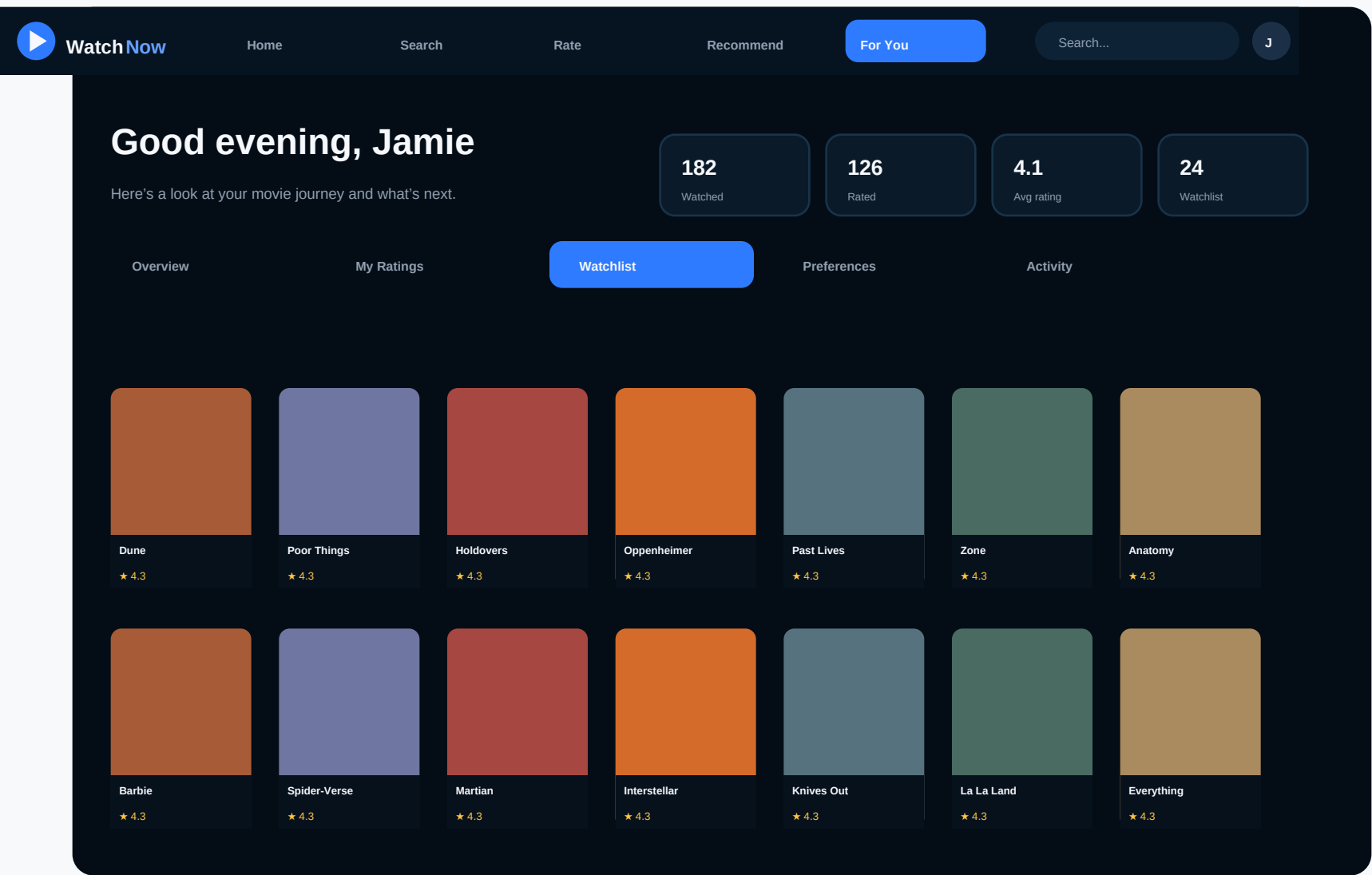
- Default sort is Most Recent.
- Filters include genre, rating range, date, and era.
- Stars can be edited in place.
- Use incremental loading with a visible count.

KEY STATES

default • filtered • editing • empty

For You Watchlist

A clean intended-viewing queue



IMPLEMENTATION NOTES

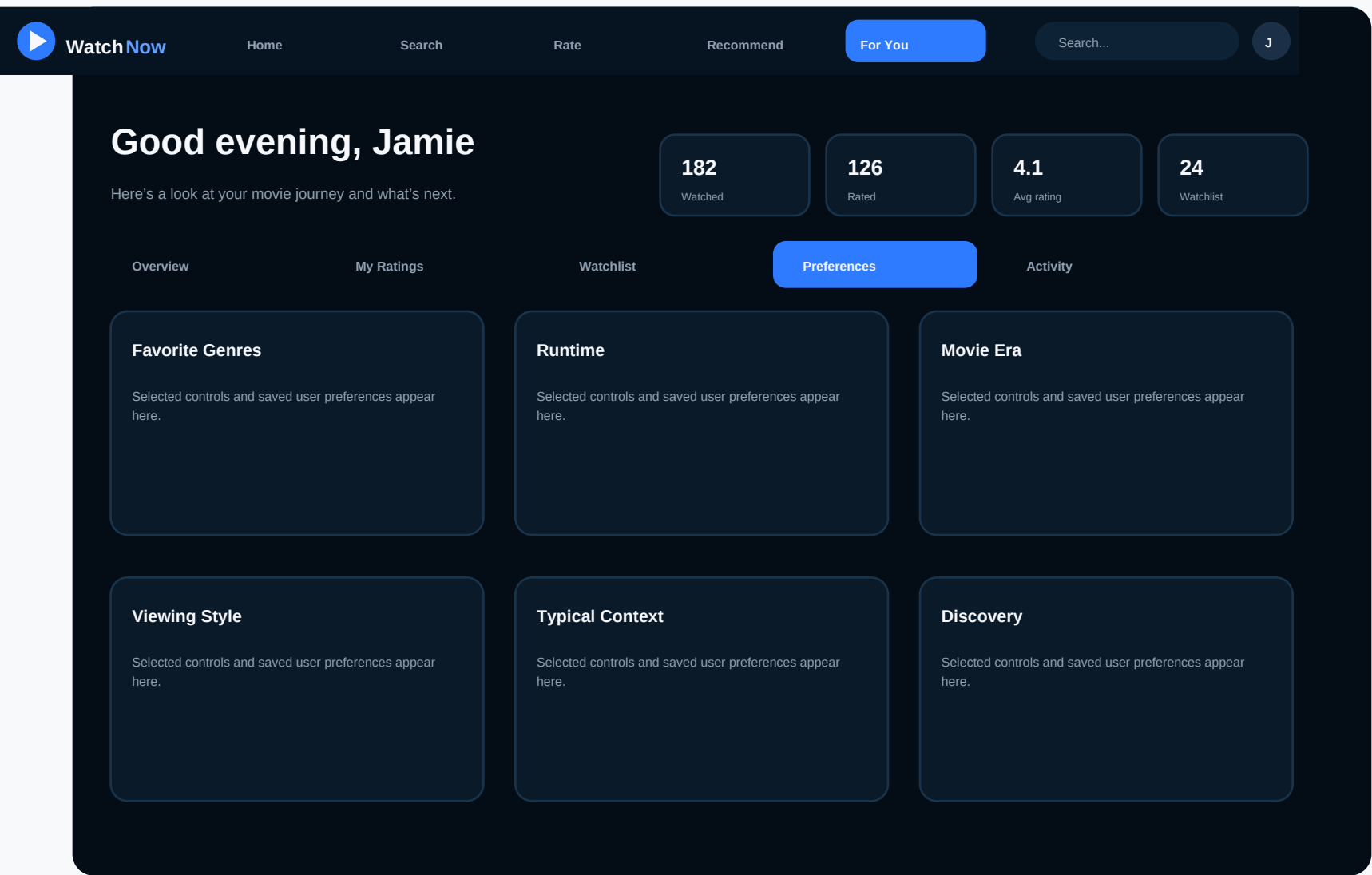
- Sort by date added, rating, runtime, or title.
- Remove is visible on focus and touch.
- Empty state links to Home and Recommend.
- Provider filters appear when availability exists.

KEY STATES

populated • filtered • empty

For You Preferences

Explicit taste controls



IMPLEMENTATION NOTES

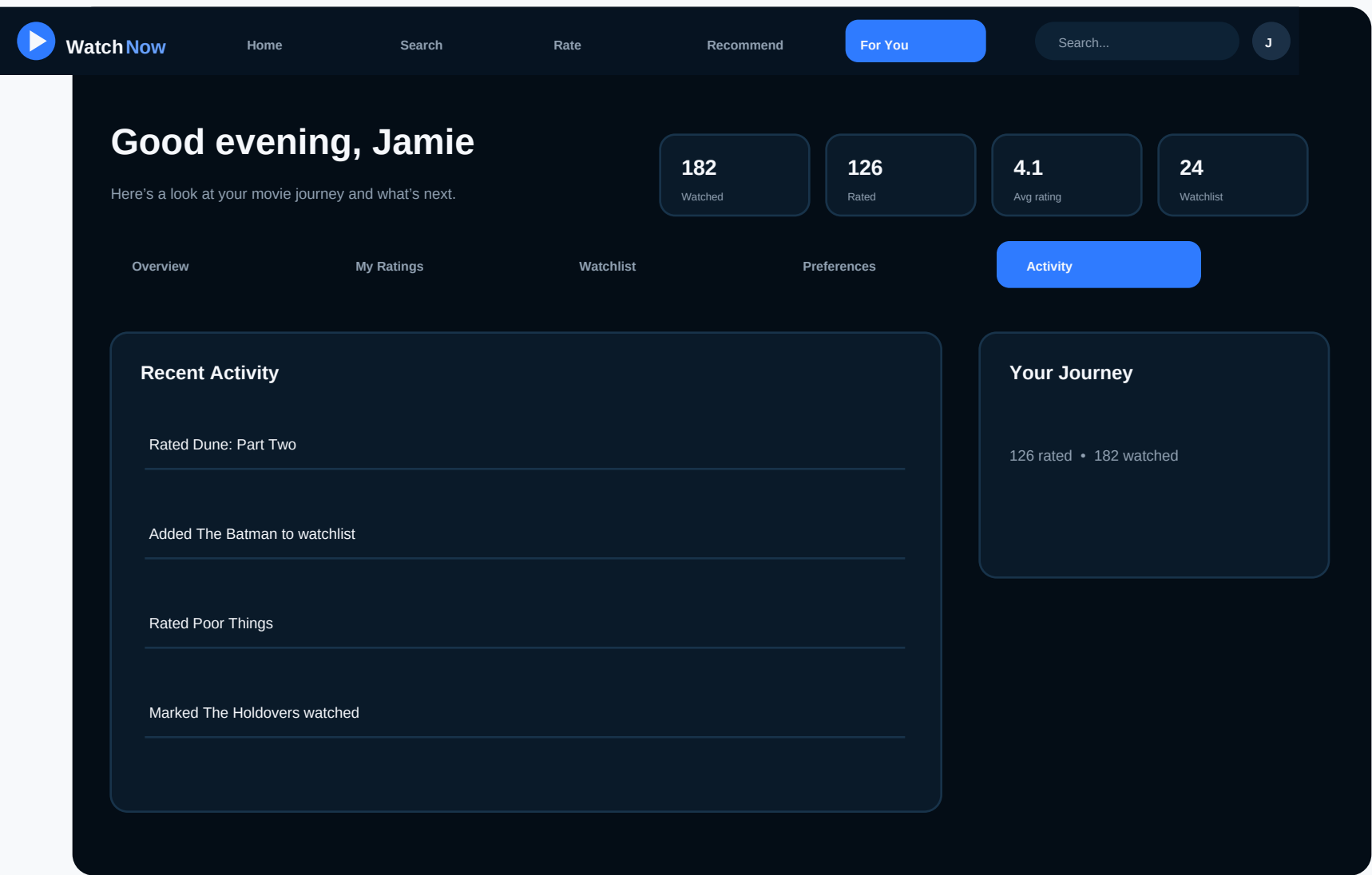
- Six grouped panels keep the form scannable.
- Use chips, radios, checkboxes, and the Discovery slider consistently.
- Explicit changes do not erase learned rating behavior.
- Save without navigating away.

KEY STATES

saved • modified • validation error

For You Activity

Transparent history



IMPLEMENTATION NOTES

- Show ratings, watched, watchlist, and preference changes.
- Use plain language and relative time.
- Group older entries by month and filter by action type.
- Allow undo for a recent accidental watchlist action.

KEY STATES

all • filtered • empty

Reusable components

Implement once and reuse. Avoid page-specific variants without a defined state.

MovieCard

poster, title, year, rating, state

FilterChip

default, hover, selected, disabled

StatCard

icon, value, short label

Tabs

route-backed active and focus states

EmptyState

short explanation and useful CTA

MovieRow

heading, See All, horizontal list

StarRating

read-only and half-star interactive

Panel

standard surface and border

ProviderBadge

service plus outbound affordance

Skeleton

shape-matched loading state

Responsive and accessibility

Preserve hierarchy and decision flow instead of shrinking the desktop canvas.

Desktop 1200+

- 72 px gutters
- 5-7 cards per row
- Full header search
- Recommend filters in one row

Tablet 768-1199

- 32 px gutters
- 3-4 cards per row
- Header search becomes icon
- Recommend filters wrap 2 by 2

Mobile under 768

- 16 px gutters
- 2 cards per grid row
- Bottom navigation
- Scrollable For You tabs

ACCESSIBILITY

WCAG AA contrast; visible blue focus rings; selection never communicated by color alone; text alternatives for charts; reduced-motion support; touch targets at least 44 px.

Claude implementation checklist

Acceptance criteria for the frontend shell. Real data and recommendation processes can be connected later.

- ☐ Brand is WatchNow everywhere: UI, metadata, routes, fixtures, and alt text.
- ☐ Every header shows the WatchNow play-mark at left and an account avatar at right.
- ☐ Palette, typography, radii, borders, and spacing match the visual system.
- ☐ All eleven designed views share one global navigation.
- ☐ Movie cards, rows, chips, tabs, stars, panels, and empty states are reusable.
- ☐ Use representative poster and backdrop images with mocked movie data from the start.
- ☐ All views work with mocked data; no real API is required for the shell.
- ☐ No play button implies that movies can be watched inside WatchNow.
- ☐ Recommend returns five cards with longer descriptions and no Why this block.
- ☐ Desktop, tablet, and mobile behavior follows the responsive rules.
- ☐ Keyboard navigation, focus visibility, reduced motion, and chart alternatives exist.